

ASHISH KOLLI

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University, Master of Science in Product Design & Development Management 2025 - 2026

Technical Coursework: Agentic Product Development, Business Model Strategy, Agile Management of Software Design.

California Polytechnic SLO, Bachelor of Architecture, Annual Morphosis Fellowship Winner 2019 - 2024

5-year accredited professional degree; trained in complex systems thinking, scale, and end-to-end design development.

EXPERIENCE

AroHai Franchise CRM - Product Founder

March 2026 - Present

Hired by 35+ unit restaurant chain (Bawarchi Biryani's) to build product for franchise governance and scale automation.

Negotiated non-exclusive agreement to develop proprietary system for chain while retaining sole ownership of SaaS build-out.

- **Designed agentic franchise CRM system** for chain to curb unit drift by identifying redundancies and returning data-driven value to each unit, turning compliance into a two-way incentive. Conducted manager interviews across all locations to determine feature prioritization. Defined product roadmap and established per-location pricing strategy.
- **Built system's AI engine with Claude Code**, benchmarking each unit's food cost variance and royalty compliance to recommend menu, purchasing, and pricing changes; designed pilot with Figma and shipped on Replit in 6 weeks.
- **Designed and launched marketing, adoption, and scaling plan** from initial 2-store pilot through roll out to all 35+ locations; set up ongoing feedback groups to drive rapid feature iteration and bug triage loops → 5 releases in 4 weeks.

Rubbermaid + Northwestern Engineering Partnership - Product Lead, ReadyVault September 2025 - June 2026

Partnership between F500 companies and Northwestern to design a product 0→1 for a specific market opportunity under the guidance of an industry executive.

- **Drove overall product vision and strategy** for creating a solution (ReadyVault) for Rubbermaid to deliver a weather-proof "toolkit" and supporting online configurator for users to customize toolkit before ordering based on needs.
- **Co-led 25+ interviews and focus groups with UX and Marketing** leads, using Gemini to synthesize findings into a needs gap analysis that defined product requirements. Delivered PRD, UX/hardware specs, and feature roadmap.
- **Led Design and Engineering team** to cut unit material cost 30% by A/B testing 12 features, specifying IP65 case, rubber handles, and clear lids; built digital kit builder in Replit with Claude Code and hardware CAD in SolidWorks.
- **Designed GTM and business model (hardware + restock subscription)** at \$249 base price with modular sub-kit upsells; pitched to VC investor panel, placing 1st of 6 teams at Northwestern's Graduate Product Pitch Competition.

Jensen Hughes - Associate Fire Protection Engineer

August 2024 - August 2025

Global engineering firm pioneering specialized technical life safety solutions with data-driven modeling and systems design.

- **Cut code review timelines 40%** and raised compliance accuracy 35% on 2 phases of TSMC Arizona GigaFab by redesigning the review workflow cross-functionally across engineering, architecture, construction, and regulators.
- **Built fire flow analysis tool in Python adopted by engineering project team**, extracting sq footage and fire code sections to model fire flow and hydraulic pressure cutting calculation time by 75% across 3 airport terminals.

Tesla - Retail Development Intern

June 2023 - September 2023

Internal infrastructure team responsible for leasing, design, and buildout of Tesla's retail showrooms and service centers.

- **Cut projected annual infrastructure costs** 10% across 45+ new service and Supercharger locations by optimizing program layout; designed retail refresh car parts display touchpoints → rolled out to 675+ sites reaching 15M+ visitors.

ADDITIONAL INTERNSHIPS

Payette Associates - Industrial Design Intern - Built 25+ high-impact physical models detailing CMF specifications, interior layouts, and massing studies across 12 project sites in healthcare, higher education, and commercial programming.

Morphosis Architects - Intern Architect - Won annual fellowship awarded to only 1 student at Cal Poly to work directly under Pritzker laureate Thom Mayne. Built a physical scale display model for Mayne's highly publicized NEOM: The Line city.

Millennial Design & Build - Project Management Intern - Coordinated specifications between contractors as client liaison.

D1 Architects and Associates - Design Intern - Presented photorealistic project visualizations room-by-room to clients.

Cal Poly Machine Shop - Student Technician - Trained 350+ students on safe operation of industrial fabrication tools.

Segal Design Institute - Teaching Assistant - Guided 3 student teams on business model design filing 2 USPTO patents.